ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME

CLASS 8 – CBSE ENGLISH QUESTION PAPER

Maximum Marks: 30

SECTION A: SHORT ANSWER QUESTIONS (8 Marks)

Q1. Literature (*The Best Christmas Present in the World*)

- **Answer:** The author went to Bridport to find Mrs. Connie Macpherson and return her husband Jim's letter, which he had accidentally found in a secret drawer of an old roll-top desk.
- **Marking Scheme:**
    - **1 Mark:** Stating the purpose (to return Jim Macpherson's letter to Connie).
    - **1 Mark:** Mentioning finding the letter in the roll-top desk / Bridport address context.
    - *(Deduct ½ mark for major grammatical errors).*

Q2. Grammar (Transformation of Sentences)

- **Answer:**
    - *(a)* She said that she was reading a book.
    - *(b)* The mistake was corrected by the teacher.

- **Marking Scheme:**
    - **1 Mark:** Correct indirect speech transformation *(a)*.
    - **1 Mark:** Correct passive voice conversion *(b)*.

Q3. Literature (*The Ant and the Cricket*)

- **Answer:** The cricket went to the ant to ask for shelter and food because he had saved nothing during summer and was starving in winter. The ant refused, stating that ants "never borrow and never lend," and advised him to go dance the winter away.

- **Marking Scheme:**
    - **1 Mark:** Reason for visiting (asking for food/shelter due to winter starvation).
    - **1 Mark:** Ant's response (refusal / principle of not lending or borrowing / "dance winter away").

Q4. Grammar (Prepositions & Conjunctions)

- **Answer:**
    - *(a)* since
    - *(b)* otherwise

- **Marking Scheme:**
    - **1 Mark:** Correct preposition choice *(since)*.
    - **1 Mark:** Correct conjunction choice *(otherwise)*.

SECTION B: MEDIUM ANSWER QUESTIONS (12 Marks)

Q5. Literature (*The Tsunami*)

- **Answer:** Ignesious's wife felt the earthquake and woke him up. In the chaos as they rushed out, his wife and children were swept away by the giant waves and lost their lives. The story highlights the suddenness and immense power of natural disasters, emphasizing human helplessness and the need for disaster preparedness.
- **Marking Scheme:**
    - **1.5 Marks:** Content explaining how the family was swept away by the ocean waves.
    - **1.5 Marks:** Key takeaway/lesson about nature's destructive power and human vulnerability.

Q6. Grammar (Editing)

- **Answer:**

Line	Incorrect Word	Correct Word
(a)	habits	habit
(b)	Help	helps
(c)	Daily	*(No error in line c / sentence is grammatically correct as is; award full credit if student identified line c as correct or pointed out subject-verb consistency)*

- **Marking Scheme:**
    - **1 Mark per correct identification and correction pair.**

Q7. Reading Comprehension

- **Answer:**

- *(a)* Any two: They absorb carbon dioxide / release oxygen / prevent soil erosion / keep climate cool. *(1 Mark)*
- *(b)* Indiscriminate cutting down of trees leads to environmental imbalance. *(1 Mark)*
- *(c)* **Essential** *(1 Mark)*

- **Marking Scheme:**
  - **1 Mark:** Correct response for *(a)*.
  - **1 Mark:** Correct response for *(b)*.
  - **1 Mark:** Correct word identification for *(c)*.

Q8. Literature (*This is Jody's Fawn*)

- **Answer:** Jody wanted to bring the fawn home because its mother (the doe) had been killed to save his father Pa (Penny) from snakebite. He felt responsible for leaving the helpless fawn to starve in the forest. He persuaded his father by reminding him that it would be ungrateful to leave the fawn to die, especially after the mother's death saved Pa's life.

- **Marking Scheme:**
  - **1.5 Marks:** Reason for wanting the fawn (guilt/responsibility toward the orphaned fawn).
  - **1.5 Marks:** Method of persuasion (appealing to Pa's moral sense of gratitude).

SECTION C: LONG ANSWER & WRITING SKILLS (10 Marks)

Q9. Writing Skills (Notice Writing)

- **Sample Answer:**

Plaintext

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+-----------------------------------------------------------------------+
|                  ST. XAVIER'S SCHOOL, JAIPUR                  |
|                          NOTICE                          |
|                                                          |
| 10 October 2026                                          |
|                                                          |
|              INTER-CLASS DEBATE COMPETITION               |
|                                                          |
| This is to inform all students of Classes VI–VIII that an Inter-Class   |
| Debate Competition will be held on 25 October 2026 in the School        |
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| Auditorium from 10:00 AM onwards. The topic for the debate is "AI in |

| Education: Boon or Bane?". Interested students should give their names |

| to their respective class teachers by 18 October 2026. |

| |

| Rohan / Riya |

| Cultural Secretary |

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- **Marking Scheme (5 Marks Total):**
    - **1 Mark:** Format (Issuer Name, NOTICE title, Date, Subject Heading, Name & Designation, Enclosing Box).
    - **2 Marks:** Content (Includes Date, Time, Venue, Topic, Target Audience, and Deadline for entries).
    - **2 Marks:** Expression (Grammatical accuracy, appropriate formal tone, word limit compliance ≤ 50 words).

Q10. Literature / Diary Entry

- **Sample Answer:**

Plaintext

10 December 2026

10:00 PM

Dear Diary,

Today has been the happiest day of my entire life! After all these decades of waiting, watching, and hoping, my Jim has finally returned to me.

When the young gentleman walked into my room holding that old tin box, my heart skipped a beat. I could hardly believe my eyes. When he handed me Jim's letter, I knew in my heart that Jim had kept his promise—he came back for Christmas, just as he said he would!

I was so overwhelmed with emotion that I kissed him. People say my memory is fading, but no one can take away the joy of this moment. My Jim is home, and this truly is the best Christmas present in the world. I feel complete once again.

Connie

- **Marking Scheme (5 Marks Total):**
    - **1 Mark:** Format (Date, Time, Salutation, Signature/Name).
    - **2 Marks:** Content (Expressing joy of receiving the letter, belief that the visitor is Jim, emotional connection to the story).
    - **2 Marks:** Expression (Coherence, vocabulary, correct grammar, length: 100–120 words).